



Part—3

Blender for Novices

Ray-tracing, Text, Movie and Game Engines

In continuation of last month's article, we carry on in our bid to illustrate the major changes in recent versions of Blender. The focus this month will be on ray-tracing, 3D text, movie creation and setting up game engines.

This is the final part in this series. In the last article, we discussed meshes, vertices and lights. Here, we will take a step forward and glance at some other recent innovations in Blender version 2.49b and above.

Ray-trace your shadows!

Ray-tracing is used to create mirrored and reflective surfaces, or to cast object shadows and transparency. It is advisable to use it

judiciously, as heavy ray-tracing tends to increase render times. In Blender 2.49b, to get ray-tracing to work, you will need to go to the *Render Buttons* menu and turn on *Ray* (see Figure 1). However, unless you are doing something as grand as animation for television, ray-tracing won't be of much use to you.

Working with 3D text

We have covered creating, editing and modifying 3D objects and scenes in detail in previous editions of *LINUX For You*. It's